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P3-99

MR. HAROLD CREED
FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION
800 N. CAPITAL N.W.
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20573

6/15/99

DEAR MR. CREEL,

I AM WRITING TO YOU TODAY REGARDING COSCO NORTH AMERICA'S 30 DAY FILING PERIOD. IT IS MY UNDERSTANDING THAT COSCO NORTH AMERICA HAS REQUESTED THE ABILITY TO FILE RATES IN A 24 HOUR PERIOD TO BE IN LINE WITH THE PROCESS CURRENTLY BEING OFFERED BY THEIR COMPETITORS.

WE WOULD LIKE TO BE A LARGER SUPPORTER OF COSCO AND UTILIZE THEIR SERVICES WHENEVER POSSIBLE. HOWEVER, ON SEVERAL OCCASIONS, WE HAVE BEEN FORCED TO USE THEIR COMPETITORS' SERVICES DUE TO THE TIME RESTRICTIONS CAUSED BY THE FILING PERIOD. IN ORDER TO BE ABLE TO SERVICE OUR CUSTOMERS, WE NEED OUR CARRIERS TO BE ABLE TO FULFILL OUR REQUIREMENTS IN A TIMELY FASHION. UNFORTUNATELY, THE 30-DAY FILING PERIOD PROHIBITS THIS.

I FEEL COSCO NORTH AMERICA SHOULD HAVE THE SAME RATE FILING PROCESS AS OTHER STEAMSHIP LINES TO BE COMPETITIVE. WE WOULD VERY MUCH LIKE TO HAVE THE ABILITY TO DO BUSINESS WITH COSCO.

YOUR ANTICIPATED COOPERATION IN RESOLVING THIS MATTER IS GREATLY APPRECIATED.

REGARDS,

PETER POLIZZI
EXPORT SUPERVISOR